Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 10 – Pull-up Master Plan

Objective

Progress from zero strict pull-ups to consistent, technically sound repetitions by improving grip, scapular control, lat strength, and relative body strength.

Phase	Weeks	Primary Work	Goal
Foundation	1–4	Scapular pull-ups, dead hangs, assisted pull-ups, negatives	Build movement pattern
Strength	5–8	Reduce assistance, longer negatives, top holds	Increase pulling strength
Performance	9–12	Strict pull-up attempts, assisted volume	Achieve first pull-up
Beyond	13+	Volume progression	Build to 5–10+ reps

Weekly Pull-up Session

1. Scapular Pull-ups – 2×8–10
2. Assisted Pull-ups – 4×4–6
3. Negative Pull-ups – 3×3 (5–8 second lowering)
4. Dead Hangs – 3×20–45 seconds
5. Neutral-Grip Lat Pulldown – 3×8–10

Technique Checklist

• Start from an active hang.
• Pull elbows toward the ribs.
• Keep your ribs down and avoid excessive swinging.
• Lower under control instead of dropping.

Common Reasons People Fail

• Only training lat pulldowns.
• Never practicing the pull-up pattern.
• Using momentum instead of strength.
• Weak grip and poor scapular control.
• Inconsistent practice.

Testing Protocol

Every fourth week, after warming up, attempt one strict pull-up before the rest of your workout. If unsuccessful, continue with your programmed assisted work. Record hang time, assistance used, and negative duration.

Coach's Advice

Your goal is not simply to perform one pull-up. Build excellent technique from the beginning. Strong scapular control and controlled negatives will accelerate progress more reliably than repeated failed

attempts.